

Azure SQL Database & Managed Instance

Intelligent, Scalable Cloud Database Service

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Engines & Compatibility Azure SQL Database, Azure SQL Managed Instance, Azure Database for PostgreSQL/MySQL/MariaDB	SLA & Availability 99.99% with zone redundancy (Business Critical/Hyperscale); 99.995% possible with geo-replication configurations. Zone-redundant HA. Active geo-replication. Auto-failover groups. Business Critical uses Always On AG. RPO/RTO: RPO 5s / RTO 30s for Business Critical geo. Near-zero with zone redundancy.
Security Controls TDE by default (AES-256). Customer-managed keys via Azure Key Vault. Always Encrypted. TLS 1.2+ required. Certs: SOC 1/2/3, ISO 27001, PCI DSS, HIPAA, FedRAMP... IAM: Azure AD authentication, Managed Identities, RBAC, Private Link, VNet integration.	Performance Hyperscale: 100TB+ storage, rapid scale-out. Business Critical: local SSD, low latency. Serverless auto-pause.
Scaling Model vCore or DTU model. Serverless auto-scale. Hyperscale read scale-out. Elastic pools.	Backup & Recovery Automated backups with PITR (up to 35 days). Long-term retention up to 10 years. Geo-redundant backups.
Pricing Structure vCore (provisioned/serverless), DTU. Reserved capacity 1/3 yr up to 80% savings. Azure Hybrid Benefit for licenses. Additional: egress, snapshots, long-term retention, vCore overages.	Reserved Capacity Reserved capacity + Hybrid Benefit + Enterprise Agreement discounts. Contact Microsoft account team.
Observability Azure Monitor, Query Performance Insight, Intelligent Insights, Log Analytics, slow query recommendations.	Support Tiers Basic, Developer, Standard, Professional Direct, Premier. Critical response <15 min on Premier.
Migration Services Azure Database Migration Service (DMS), Data Migration Assistant, native tools, Striim.	Network & Private Access Private Link, VNet service endpoints, ExpressRoute. Egress charged per Azure rates.
Data Centers Global: Central India, South India, West US, East US, West Europe, North Europe, Japan East, Korea Central, Australia East, Brazil South.	Known Limitations Some SQL Server features differ in PaaS; max DTU/vCore limits per tier; maintenance windows.

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